to make fundamental changes to the way the community had functioned until the Yom Kippur War.

Zvi Zamir appointed me as secretary of the committee. Under his guidance, a platform was prepared for discussion, entitled “The State Intelligence Assessment.” The document contained seventeen pages. The committee held two lengthy discussions, after which a report comprising recommendations and reservations was submitted to the prime minister on May 8, 1974. Following a discussion with the prime minister held on August 18, 1974, the report was returned to the committee in order to reprocess its proposals and recommendations. Discussions to bridge the gaps continued until August 25, when the final text was prepared for submission to the prime minister.

At this stage, the committee’s work was completed and there was no continuation. The final version of its recommendations was never discussed with Prime Minister Rabin. Zamir refused to be appointed intelligence adviser to the prime minister and retired from the service.

What had happened behind the scenes? The head of MI, Major General Shlomo Gazit, fought throughout the committee’s deliberations to preserve MI’s status as the national assessor. The head of the Shin Bet, Yossef Harmelin, supported Gazit’s position, and the director general of the Prime Minister’s Office, Mordechai Gazit (who was, incidentally, Shlomo Gazit’s older brother), was absent from the committee’s meetings because he was busy accompanying US secretary of state Henry Kissinger, who was visiting Israel at the time. Avraham Kidron, director general of the Foreign Ministry, was the only one of the committee’s members who supported Zamir’s position.

Throughout the period of the committee’s work, Zamir was in regular contact with Rabin, and in conversations between them Rabin led Zamir to understand that he did not want to impose Zamir’s opinions and recommendations on the IDF in general and on MI in particular so soon after being appointed prime minister. Rabin did not rule out the possibility that such a confrontation had the potential for a crisis in government. It is also possible that Rabin, who had been caught up in struggles and even disputes with Defense Minister Shimon Peres since his first day as prime minister, feared that accepting Zamir’s recommendations might provide Peres with another pretext for dispute. Rabin thus refrained from adopting Zamir’s